
Paper 2, Option 2G.2: Spain, 1930–78: republicanism, Francoism and the re-establishment of democracy

Overview

This option comprises a study in depth of Spain in the years 1930–78, a dramatic period for Spaniards which spanned years of democracy, dictatorship and then democracy again, and led to the creation of the modern Spanish state.

Students will gain an in-depth understanding of the changing politics and society of a nation that underwent the turbulence of the Second Republic and civil war followed by a period of right-wing dictatorship from which a modern democracy emerged.

Key topics	Content
1 Creation and destabilisation of the Second Republic, 1930–36	- Spain, 1930–31: impact of political events, 1930–31 and the creation of the Second Republic; forces of conservatism, including landowners, church, army; political unrest; economic and social problems. - Years of reform, 1931–33: Provisional government reform of the army and the church; tackling agricultural problems; reforms under Azana; responses from both left and right; unrest and repression. - Years of reaction, 1933–36: creation of CEDA; impact of the 1933 elections; undoing the reforms of 1931–33; the Asturias rising and its consequences; formation of the Popular Front. - The failure of the Popular Front 1936: election of February 1936; political instability and social unrest; the significance of Sotelo's assassination; the attempted coup July 1936.
2 The Spanish Civil War, 1936–39	- Spain at the outbreak of war July–August 1936: Nationalist and Republican leadership, support and relative military strength; the geographical division of the country; the significance of the international response; the situation by the end of August. - The course of the war: the main campaigns and stages of the Nationalist advance; the impact of Republican political divisions; the impact of atrocities by both sides; the fall of Barcelona and Madrid in 1939. - Life during the war: the variety of experiences in the Republican zones; life in the Nationalist zone; attitudes towards women; the use of political terror.

Key topics	Content
3 Establishing Franco's dictatorship, 1938–56	• Creation of the 'new state': establishing control in the Nationalist zone 1938; initial policies; the influence of the <i>Falange</i>; managing Nationalist rivalries; the establishment and survival of a fascist dictatorship under Franco. • Controlling society: the legacy of the civil war; political terror and repression; censorship; the role of the church; propaganda; cult of personality; education policies; attitudes towards women. • Economic development: economic problems and the impact of the civil war; the development of corporatism; the implementation of autarky; successes and failures. • The dictatorship and foreign relations, 1939–56: maintaining neutrality, 1939–45; creating international relationships in the Cold War environment, 1945–56.
4 Dictatorship remodelled and the transition to democracy, 1956–78	• Economic and social change, 1956–75: economic problems, the decline of the <i>Falange</i> and rise of the technocrats in the late 1950s; the 'economic miracle', 1960–75 and impact of the growth of tourism; social developments and tensions. • Political developments, 1956–75: the reasons for, and nature of, political change, 1956–70; the changing influence of the church; the reasons for, and nature of, increased opposition to Franco's rule; the growth of regional nationalism; government reaction, 1970–75; developments in international relations. • Planning and managing succession: the Law of Leadership Succession 1947; the decision to return to monarchy 1969; reaction to the decision from reformers and conservatives; the role of Juan Carlos, 1969–74; the death of Franco 1975. • Transition to democracy: the role of Juan Carlos; immediate steps towards democracy; conservative obstacles; agreeing a democratic constitution in 1978.

Route H: Democracies in change: Britain and the USA in the twentieth century

Overview

Students taking Route H will study:

- *Paper 1, Option 1H: Britain transformed, 1918–97*

and **either**:

- *Paper 2, Option 2H.1: The USA, c1920–55: boom, bust and recovery*

or:

- *Paper 2, Option 2H.2: The USA, 1955–92: conformity and challenge.*

In the twentieth century, liberal democracies came under increasing challenge from both within and without. The options in Route H allow students to understand the nature, and effectiveness, of the response to these challenges.

Studying two different countries allows students to develop a greater understanding of the challenges experienced by Britain and the USA, and of the contrasts and similarities in the responses (although students will not be required to answer comparative questions that link the breadth and the chosen depth option).